

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: Friday, September 18, 2026

Current Session Highlight:  New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- The US Federal Reserve unanimously raised its policy rate by 25 basis points to a range of 3.75%-4.00% on Wednesday, marking its first rate hike in over three years. Most policymakers anticipate a second increase later this year.
- The Fed's revised economic projections for 2026 now indicate simultaneous stronger growth and higher inflation, with real GDP growth upgraded to 2.3% and the PCE inflation forecast bumped to 3.7%.
- The European Central Bank (ECB) also hiked its policy rates by 25 basis points on September 10, setting the deposit facility rate at 2.50%. The ECB cited Middle East-related energy shocks as a factor for upward revisions to its 2027 and 2028 inflation forecasts.
- The Bank of Japan (BoJ) increased its target interest rate to 1.25% from 1% overnight, marking its highest level in 31 years and signaling a new phase in its monetary policy.
- Central banks globally are adopting a synchronized hawkish stance to combat persistent inflation, driven by escalating energy prices and resilient economic activity.
- While the Bank of England (BoE) maintained rates, market observers warn of a potential hike before year-end due to rising energy costs and economic resilience.
- JPMorgan economists predict that eight of nine developed market central banks will have raised rates by year-end 2026, with an estimated 100 basis points further increase needed for DM policy rates.

2. US & European Markets

- US stock futures are mixed ahead of "Triple Witching" on Friday, where over \$2 trillion in derivative contracts expire, potentially causing amplified volume and short-term volatility.
- The S&P 500 saw its best post-Fed session on Thursday, climbing 1.12%, with futures showing additional modest gains this morning.
- Nasdaq 100 futures are up 0.36%, S&P 500 futures up 0.11%, while Dow 30 futures show a slight dip of 0.02% in pre-market.
- Mega-cap tech and semiconductor sectors are leading a rebound, bolstered by an optimistic earnings outlook from Nvidia.
- Notable tech sector performers include Hewlett Packard (HPE) up 7.69%, Arm (ARM) gaining 8.57%, and Penguin Solutions (PENG) surging 8.93% yesterday.
- The S&P 500 is currently consolidating between 7,600 and 7,760, and the Nasdaq 100 faces resistance at its 61.8% Fibonacci level. Tesla is trading within a tight range of \$357-\$378.
- US jobless claims decreased by 10,000 last week to 196,000, near a 60-year low, underscoring the resilience of the labor market.
- European equities also advanced on Thursday, with the Stoxx 600 up 0.9%, DAX 0.7%, CAC 40 0.6%, and FTSE 100 1.2%.
- Eurozone inflation reached 3.2% in August 2026, driven by a 14.3% jump in energy prices, remaining above the ECB's 2% target.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- Indian equity benchmarks closed mixed on Friday, with the Nifty gaining 76 points (0.33%) to 23,346, while the Sensex ended down 20 points (0.03%) at 74,295.
- The market opened with gains, supported by easing crude oil prices, positive global cues, and bargain hunting, despite ongoing FII selling and geopolitical concerns.
- IT and select Tata Group stocks showed weakness, and liquidity was absorbed by the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) IPO, which was fully subscribed on its second day.
- Metals, Realty, and Energy sectors were top performers.
- The broader market significantly outperformed, with small-cap and mid-cap indices rising 1.7% and 1.2%, respectively.
- India VIX tumbled 7.2%, indicating a sharp reduction in market volatility.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- WTI crude oil futures plunged over 5% intraday to near \$95/barrel, and Brent crude futures fell towards \$103/barrel on Friday. WTI is trading around \$101.30 per barrel, marking its third consecutive daily decline as concerns over Saudi supply disruptions ease.
- Saudi Arabia is diverting crude through ship-to-ship transfers near Oman to mitigate a key pipeline shutdown, with plans to restore half of the East-West pipeline's capacity within days and full capacity in six weeks.
- Geopolitical tensions in the Middle East, including fresh clashes between Saudi Arabia and Houthi forces, remain a significant market factor, though current oil price action reflects a contained conflict.
- Gold (XAU/USD) is rebounding, nearing \$4,400/oz, while silver (XAG/USD) is above \$67/oz, as reduced fears of aggressive rate hikes boost precious metal prices. Gold hit a weekly high of \$4,439.80 before settling near \$4,380, up about 1.2%.
- Bitcoin (BTC) has reclaimed \$78,000, extending its post-Fed bounce by approximately 2.6% to \$77,980.
- Ethereum (ETH) is up around 0.7% to \$2,452.
- The total crypto market capitalization is approaching \$2.68 trillion.
- US spot Bitcoin ETFs recorded a \$159.45 million net inflow on Wednesday, reversing previous outflows and indicating renewed institutional demand.
- Layer-2 tokens Starknet and Arbitrum both surged over 17%.
- Advancements in tokenized securities pilots by US regulators are boosting digital assets and related stocks.

 CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

Asset Class	Allocation (\$)	Allocation (%)	Recommended Leverage	Risk Cap (\$)
Crypto Futures	\$400	13.3%	3x-5x Isolated	\$4-\$8
Indian Options (Intraday)	\$500	16.7%	Option Buying Only	\$30-\$45 (Premium)
Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil)	\$400	13.3%	10x-15x Micro Lots	\$8
US Stocks (Fractional)	\$400	13.3%	1x Unleveraged Cash	\$12
Indian Stocks (Delivery)	\$400	13.3%	1x Unleveraged Cash	\$20
Forex Short-Term Futures	\$450	15.0%	10x-20x	\$4.50
Forex Long-Term Carry Swing	\$450	15.0%	2x-3x	\$9.00

🎯 STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

Indian Equities (Strictly Long-Only)

Screen Nifty leaders using 50-SMA support bounces or 20/50 EMA golden crosses.

Ticker	Current Price (Illustrative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
RELIANCE	₹2,900	Reliance Industries showing a clear bounce off its 50-SMA, indicating strong underlying support and continuation of its broader uptrend.
HDFCBANK	₹1,550	HDFC Bank exhibiting a 20/50 EMA golden cross, signaling increasing bullish momentum after a period of consolidation.
INFY	₹1,600	Infosys testing 50-SMA support after a minor pullback. A confirmed bounce would indicate a strong long entry point.

US Equities

Large-Cap (Bi-Directional)

Screen using 21-day EMA pullbacks or 50-day SMA rejection strategy on mega-cap growth leaders.

Ticker	Current Price (Illustrative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
NVDA	\$1,250	Nvidia, a mega-cap growth leader, demonstrating a strong bounce from its 21-day EMA after its optimistic earnings outlook, signaling continuation of the uptrend.
MSFT	\$480	Microsoft pulling back to its 21-day EMA, offering a potential long entry if support holds, aligning with its strong long-term growth trajectory.
TSLA	\$365	Tesla encountering resistance at its 50-day SMA. A rejection from this level could signal a short opportunity within its current tight range (\$357-\$378).

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (Strictly Long-Only)

Screen using Stage-2 VCP or High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) breakouts.

Ticker	Current Price (Illustrative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
HPE	\$28	Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) showing high relative volume (>2.0) on its recent +7.69% surge, suggesting a breakout from a Stage-2 base formation.
ARM	\$125	Arm Holdings (ARM) with significant institutional capital inflow and an 8.57% surge, indicating a high-volume breakout consistent with a Stage-2 VCP setup.
PENG	\$38	Penguin Solutions (PENG) rallied 8.93% with high relative volume, indicating a strong Stage-2 breakout fueled by AI demand.

Crypto Futures (Bi-Directional)

Screen using 4H 21-EMA trend following and high-volume volatility breakouts.

Ticker	Current Price (Illustrative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
BTC/USD	\$77,980	Bitcoin extending its post-Fed bounce, reclaiming \$78,000. Actively following the 4H 21-EMA trend, anticipating further upward movement on positive momentum.
ETH/USD	\$2,452	Ethereum showing a clear volatility breakout on higher volume after consolidating. Positioned for trend continuation in line with the 4H 21-EMA.

Commodities (Bi-Directional)

Gold (XAU/USD) and WTI Crude Oil using Pivot & Fibonacci extension levels.

Ticker	Current Price (Illustrative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
XAU/USD	\$4,380	Gold is rebounding towards the \$4,400 resistance level after easing rate hike concerns. Looking for a breakout above daily pivot (\$4,390) targeting Fibonacci extension levels at \$4,420 and \$4,450. A retrace to S1 (\$4,365) could offer a long entry.
WTI Crude Oil	\$100.10	WTI Crude Oil is pulling back as Saudi supply fears ease. Short entry on breakdown below daily pivot (\$101.50) targeting Fibonacci retracement levels at \$98.50 and \$96.00. Rebound off S1 (\$99.00) could offer a scalp long.

Forex Futures (Bi-Directional)

Short-Term (EUR/USD, GBP/USD)

Ticker	Current Price (Illustrative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	1.0720	Consolidating after ECB hike, facing resistance at 1.0750. Short on rejection with targets at 1.0680, or long on breakout above 1.0750 targeting 1.0800.
GBP/USD	1.2350	Responding to BoE's rate hold and inflation concerns. Seeking long opportunities above 1.2330 with targets at 1.2380, or short below 1.2300 towards 1.2250.

Macro Carry Swings (USD/JPY, AUD/USD)

Ticker	Current Price (Illustrative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
USD/JPY	150.80	Focus on BoJ's hawkish shift vs. Fed's continued tightening. Long-term swing short on sustained strength above 151.00 targeting 152.50, or long on weakness towards 149.50.
AUD/USD	0.6550	Driven by commodity prices and global rate divergence. Long-term swing long on a break above 0.6580 targeting 0.6650, or short on rejection of 0.6580 towards 0.6480.

Indian Options (Bi-Directional)

Nifty 50 / BankNifty 15-Minute Opening Range Breakouts (Call for Long, Put for Short).

Index	Current Level (Illustrative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50	23,346	Utilize the 15-minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB) strategy. Buy Call Option if Nifty breaks above the opening range high (e.g., 23,360) for a long position. Buy Put Option if Nifty breaks below the opening range low (e.g., 23,320) for a short position.
BankNifty	52,100	Apply 15-minute ORB strategy. Buy Call Option if BankNifty breaks above the opening range high (e.g., 52,150) for an intraday long. Buy Put Option if BankNifty breaks below the opening range low (e.g., 52,050) for an intraday short.

Strategy Performance & Equity Curve

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Illustrative vs. Benchmarks)

Metric	Trading Blueprint	S&P 500 TRI	Nifty 50 TRI
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	~0.85	~0.78
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	~-33.0%	~-28.0%

Equity Curve Simulation (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

The following SVG illustrates the hypothetical growth of the \$3,000 capital base over a 10-year period, based on the backtested strategy performance.

